

INSURANCE BOOST

A MUCH-AWAITED reform, the Insurance Amendment Bill was finally introduced in Parliament in the Winter Session and passed, enabling 100% foreign direct investment in the sector, up from the earlier cap of 74%. The Sabka Bima Sabka Suraksha (Amendment of Insurance Laws) Act, 2025, which overhauls the Insurance Act, 1938, the IRDA Act, 1999, and the LIC Act, 1956, is expected to boost capital flows and enable domestic players to expand their business as well as increase insurance penetration. It also enables the merger of an insurance company with a non-insurance firm, if the combined entity is in the insurance business. The space is set for more action now.



RURAL EMPLOYMENT SHIFT

IN A SWEEPING revamp of the flagship rural employment guarantee scheme, the government has introduced the Viksit Bharat Guarantee for Rozgar and Aajeevika Mission (Gramin) Bill, 2025, and has received President's assent. The Bill will replace the two-decades-old Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act, 2005. While it guarantees more days of wage employment to rural households—125 days as against 100 days as of now—Opposition parties have raised questions over the cost sharing pattern, where states will have to bear a higher burden, as well as the decision to remove Mahatma Gandhi's name. With several changes proposed even as the rural economy undergoes a shift, how this plays out is to be seen.

OZEMPIC, NOW IN INDIA

NOVO NORDISK HAS launched its blockbuster anti-diabetes drug Ozempic in India, stepping up its push in the diabetes and obesity treatment market as competition with Eli Lilly intensifies. The roll-out follows a 37% price cut on Wegovy, aimed at expanding access amid rising pressure in GLP-1 therapies. With semaglutide entering a later phase of its patent cycle, Vikrant Shrotriya, managing director of Novo Nordisk India says the company is refining its India strategy around pricing, scale and partnerships, while preparing newer obesity drugs to defend market share against global rivals.



**\$292
BILLION**

INDIA'S TOTAL EXPORTS IN FY26 TILL NOVEMBER. IT WAS \$284.6 BILLION IN THE CORRESPONDING PERIOD (APRIL TO NOVEMBER) IN FY25